

1984 NBA Finals

The **1984 NBA World Championship Series** was the championship round of the National Basketball Association's (NBA) 1983–84 season, and the culmination of the season's playoffs.^[1] The Eastern Conference champion Boston Celtics defeated the Western Conference champion Los Angeles Lakers in seven games. Celtics forward Larry Bird averaged 27 points and 14 rebounds a game during the series, earning the NBA Finals Most Valuable Player (MVP). The 1984 NBA Finals has been often regarded as one of the greatest finals ever played, and is considered the "peak" of the 1980s Celtics-Lakers rivalry

This series was a rematch of the Los Angeles Lakers and Boston Celtics after their rivalry was revived in 1979 with the Magic Johnson–Larry Bird pair entering the league. After alternating wins with the Lakers, the Celtics won Game 7 and the series with a score of 111–102.

This was the last NBA Finals to use the 2–2–1–1–1 format until 2014. The following year, the NBA Finals format was changed to 2–3–2 after Celtics president Red Auerbach complained to NBA Commissioner David Stern about the constant travel during the Finals (at the time, all NBA teams still traveled primarily by commercial aircraft, and players were sometimes forced to cram themselves into coach seats if first or business class seats were not available).^{[2][3][4][5]} Although the 2–2–1–1–1 format remained intact for the remainder of the playoff rounds, the 2–3–2 format would be used up through 2013.

As of 2025, MLB is the only major professional sports league to retain the 2-3-2 format for its playoff series.^[6]

Background

The seeds of the 1984 Finals were first sown five years earlier, during the 1979 NCAA Men's Division I Basketball Tournament. In the final game of the tournament, Larry Bird and his erstwhile unbeaten Indiana State Sycamores lost to Magic Johnson and his Michigan State Spartans by the score of 75–64. After the tournament, both entered the NBA in the 1979–80 season with high expectations. Bird, who was selected 6th in the 1978 NBA draft but committed back to Indiana State for his senior season, was named Rookie of the Year after leading the Celtics to a 32-game turnaround from the previous year, going from 29 to 61 wins. The expected Celtics–Lakers finals, however, never happened. The Philadelphia 76ers defeated the Celtics in the conference finals before losing to the Lakers in the 1980 NBA Finals, with Johnson earning Finals MVP honors for his Game 6 performance. Since then Bird won a championship in 1981, then Magic led the Lakers to the finals in 1982 and 1983, winning in the former.

Boston Celtics

In the 1983–84 season, the Celtics won 62 games to lead the league. The Celtics were led by Bird, who won his first MVP award, and was complemented by 1981 Finals MVP Cedric Maxwell, first-time all-star and Sixth Man Award winner Kevin McHale, Robert Parish, Gerald Henderson and Danny Ainge. Boston's most crucial addition was Dennis Johnson, whom they acquired from the Phoenix Suns in the offseason in hopes of addressing their porous back-court defense.

In the playoffs, the Celtics defeated the Washington Bullets in four, the New York Knicks in seven, and the Milwaukee Bucks in five.

Los Angeles Lakers

The Lakers were coming off a four-game sweep by the Philadelphia 76ers in the previous year's finals. Before the season began, the Lakers traded long-time guard Norm Nixon to the San Diego Clippers in exchange for the draft rights to Byron Scott. The trade signaled a transition period, as some of the key players from the first two championships gave way to younger talent. Despite the changes, it did not stop the Lakers from finishing with the best record (54–28) in the Western Conference, powered by their one-two punch of Kareem Abdul-Jabbar and Magic Johnson.

During the playoffs, the Lakers defeated the Kansas City Kings in three, the Dallas Mavericks in five, and the Phoenix Suns in six. However, the Lakers suffered a key injury when their 3rd leading scorer, Jamaal Wilkes (17 PPG) was ruled out of the finals. This cost the Lakers valuable depth, as James Worthy, a key contributor off the bench, would now have to start in Wilkes' place.

1984 NBA Finals

Team	Coach	Wins
Boston Celtics	K.C. Jones	4
Los Angeles Lakers	Pat Riley	3
Dates	May 27–June 12	
MVP	<u>Larry Bird</u> (Boston Celtics)	
Hall of Famers	Celtics: <u>Larry Bird</u> (1998) <u>Dennis Johnson</u> (2010) <u>Kevin McHale</u> (1999) <u>Robert Parish</u> (2003) Lakers: <u>Kareem Abdul-Jabbar</u> (1995) <u>Michael Cooper</u> (2024) <u>Magic Johnson</u> (2002) <u>Bob McAdoo</u> (2000) <u>Jamaal Wilkes</u> (2012) <u>James Worthy</u> (2003) Coaches: <u>K.C. Jones</u> (1989, player) <u>Pat Riley</u> (2008) Officials: <u>Darell Garretson</u> (2016) <u>Hugh Evans</u> (2022) <u>Earl Strom</u> (1995)	
Eastern finals	<u>Celtics</u> defeated <u>Bucks</u> , 4–1	
Western finals	<u>Lakers</u> defeated <u>Suns</u> , 4–2	

Road to the Finals

Los Angeles Lakers (Western Conference champion)						Regular season	Boston Celtics (Eastern Conference champion)					
#	Western Conference						#	Eastern Conference				
	Team	W	L	PCT	GB			Team	W	L	PCT	GB
1	c- Los Angeles Lakers	54	28	.659	–		1	z- Boston Celtics	62	20	.756	–
2	y- Utah Jazz	45	37	.549	9		2	y- Milwaukee Bucks	50	32	.610	–
3	x- Portland Trail Blazers	48	34	.585	6		3	x- Philadelphia 76ers	52	30	.634	–
4	x- Dallas Mavericks	43	39	.524	11		4	x- Detroit Pistons	49	33	.598	–
5	x- Seattle SuperSonics	42	40	.512	12		5	x- New York Knicks	47	35	.573	–
6	x- Phoenix Suns	41	41	.500	13		6	x- New Jersey Nets	45	37	.549	–
7	x- Denver Nuggets	38	44	.463	16		7	x- Atlanta Hawks	40	42	.488	–
8	x- Kansas City Kings	38	44	.463	16		8	x- Washington Bullets	35	47	.427	–
9	San Antonio Spurs	37	45	.451	17		9	Cleveland Cavaliers	28	54	.341	–
10	Golden State Warriors	37	45	.451	17		10	Chicago Bulls	27	55	.329	–
11	San Diego Clippers	30	52	.366	24		11	Indiana Pacers	26	56	.317	–
12	Houston Rockets	29	53	.354	25	1st seed in the East, best league record						
1st seed in the West, 2nd best league record						First round	Defeated the (8) Washington Bullets , 3–1					
Defeated the (8) Kansas City Kings , 3–0						Conference semifinals	Defeated the (5) New York Knicks , 4–3					
Defeated the (4) Dallas Mavericks , 4–1						Conference finals	Defeated the (2) Milwaukee Bucks , 4–1					
Defeated the (6) Phoenix Suns , 4–2												

Regular season series

The [Los Angeles Lakers](#) won both games in the regular season series:

February 8, 1984	Los Angeles Lakers 111, Boston Celtics 109	Boston Garden , Boston , Massachusetts
February 24, 1984	Boston Celtics 108, Los Angeles Lakers 116	The Forum , Los Angeles , California

Series summary

Game	Date	Road team	Result	Home team
Game 1	May 27	Los Angeles Lakers	115–109 (1–0)	Boston Celtics
Game 2	May 31	Los Angeles Lakers	121–124 (OT) (1–1)	Boston Celtics
Game 3	June 3	Boston Celtics	104–137 (1–2)	Los Angeles Lakers
Game 4	June 6	Boston Celtics	129–125 (OT) (2–2)	Los Angeles Lakers
Game 5	June 8	Los Angeles Lakers	103–121 (2–3)	Boston Celtics
Game 6	June 10	Boston Celtics	108–119 (3–3)	Los Angeles Lakers
Game 7	June 12	Los Angeles Lakers	102–111 (3–4)	Boston Celtics

Game 1

May 27	Los Angeles Lakers 115 , Boston Celtics 109	Boston Garden , Boston , Massachusetts	CBS
Scoring by quarter: 34–22, 31–30, 27–36, 23–21		Attendance: 14,890	
Pts: Kareem Abdul-Jabbar 32		Referees:	
Rebs: Kareem Abdul-Jabbar 8		▪ No. 25 Hugh Evans	
Asts: Magic Johnson 10		▪ No. 8 John Vanak	
Asts: Larry Bird 14			
Asts: Larry Bird 5			
Los Angeles leads the series, 1–0			

Led by [Magic Johnson](#), the [Lakers](#) fast break offense scored 52 points en route to a 115–109 victory at [Boston Garden](#) to open the series.^[7]

Game 2

May 31	<u>Los Angeles Lakers</u> 121, Boston Celtics 124 (OT)	<u>Boston Garden</u> , <u>Boston</u> , <u>Massachusetts</u>	<u>CBS</u>		
Scoring by quarter: 26–36, 33–25, 28–29, 26–23, Overtime: 8–11					
Pts: James Worthy 29		Pts: Larry Bird 27			
Rebs: Magic Johnson 10		Rebs: Larry Bird 13			
<u>Asts: Magic Johnson 10</u>		Asts: Ainge, Henderson 5 each			
<i>Series tied, 1–1</i>					
Referees: - No. 14 Jack Madden - No. 11 Jake O'Donnell					

In Game 2, the [Lakers](#) led 113–111 with 18 seconds left when [Gerald Henderson](#) stole a [James Worthy](#) pass to score a game tying layup. The [Lakers](#) then inbounded the ball and [Magic Johnson](#) inexplicably dribbled the clock out during regulation time. With the [Celtics](#) down by one near the end of overtime, [Scott Wedman](#) hit a shot from the baseline with 14 seconds remaining to put [Boston](#) ahead. The [Lakers'](#) chance to win on the ensuing

possession was thwarted by a [Robert Parish](#) steal, followed by [Larry Bird](#) sinking a pair of free throws to secure the 124–121 victory for the Celtics.^[7]

Game 3

June 3	Boston Celtics 104, Los Angeles Lakers 137 Scoring by quarter: 26–29, 20–28, 33–47, 25–33 Pts: Larry Bird 30 Pts: Kareem Abdul-Jabbar 24 Rebs: Robert Parish 12 Rebs: Magic Johnson 11 Asts: Cedric Maxwell 5 Asts: Magic Johnson 21 <i>Los Angeles lead the series, 2–1</i>	The Forum, Inglewood, California CBS Attendance: 17,505 Referees: ■ No. 22 Paul Mihalak ■ No. 12 Earl Strom
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In Game 3, the Lakers raced to an easy 137–104 victory as [Magic Johnson](#) dished out 21 assists, an NBA Finals record. After the game, [Larry Bird](#) said his team played like "sissies" in an attempt to light a fire under his teammates. It was Boston's worst playoff defeat in franchise history to that date.

Game 4

June 6	Boston Celtics 129, Los Angeles Lakers 125 (OT) Scoring by quarter: 32–33, 26–35, 30–22, 25–23, Overtime: 16–12 Pts: Larry Bird 29 Pts: Kareem Abdul-Jabbar 32 Rebs: Larry Bird 21 Rebs: Magic Johnson 11 Asts: Dennis Johnson 14 Asts: Magic Johnson 17 <i>Series tied, 2–2</i>	The Forum, Inglewood, California CBS Attendance: 17,505 Referees: ■ No. 10 Darell Garretson ■ No. 20 Jess Kersey
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In Game 4, the Lakers had a five-point game lead with less than a minute to play, but made several execution errors, including [Magic Johnson's](#) bad pass to [Robert Parish](#) late in the fourth quarter, and missing two crucial free throws in OT as the Celtics tied the game and then came away with a 129–125 victory in overtime. Johnson was called "Tragic Johnson" by Celtics fans due to the two crucial errors he committed in Game 4 (the Parish steal, followed by two botched free throws in OT). The Lakers took an early lead in overtime, but a controversial foul call on [Kareem Abdul-Jabbar](#), with 16 seconds remaining in regulation, had been his 6th foul, and he was out of the game. The Laker momentum was stalled, and [Larry Bird](#) came up with a crucial jumper over [Magic Johnson](#) with 16 seconds remaining in overtime, then [M.L. Carr](#) stole [James Worthy's](#) inbound pass followed by a dunk to seal the win. The game was also marked by Celtic forward [Kevin McHale's](#) clothesline take-down of Laker forward [Kurt Rambis](#) on a breakaway layup which triggered the physical aspect of the rivalry. [Larry Bird](#) would go after [Kareem Abdul-Jabbar](#) later on in the third quarter, and 1981 Finals MVP [Cedric Maxwell](#) further antagonized the Lakers by following a missed [James Worthy](#) free throw by crossing the lane with his hands around his own neck, symbolizing that Worthy was "choking" under pressure. Also, Bird pushed [Michael Cooper](#) to the baseline following the inbound play during the second quarter.

Game 4 of the 1984 Finals marked the last Finals game to go into overtime until [Game 2 of the 1990 NBA Finals](#).

Game 5

June 8	Los Angeles Lakers 103, Boston Celtics 121 Scoring by quarter: 26–26, 27–29, 24–33, 26–33 Pts: James Worthy 22 Pts: Larry Bird 34 Rebs: Kurt Rambis 9 Rebs: Larry Bird 17 Asts: Magic Johnson 13 Asts: Gerald Henderson 9 <i>Boston leads the series, 3–2</i>	Boston Garden, Boston, Massachusetts CBS Attendance: 14,890 Referees: ■ No. 25 Hugh Evans ■ No. 12 Earl Strom ■ No. 9 John Vanak (alternate, replaced Evans)
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In Game 5, the Celtics took a 3–2 series lead with a 121–103 victory, as [Larry Bird](#) scored 34 points and grabbed 17 rebounds. The game was known as the "Heat Game", as it was played under 97 °F (36 °C) heat, and without any air conditioning, at [Boston Garden](#). The Celtics did not warm up with their sweat pants on because of extreme heat, and an [oxygen tank](#) was provided to give air to an aging [Kareem Abdul-Jabbar](#). Referee [Hugh Evans](#) became dehydrated and fainted at one point in the first half. He worked the first half, but was replaced by [John Vanak](#) for the second half.^[8] It was also the last time that a team with home court advantage in the NBA finals played Game 5 on its own floor until 2014. The next year, the NBA Finals switched to the 2-3-2 format with Game 5 going to the team without home-court advantage, which continued through 2013.

Game 6

June 10	Boston Celtics 108, Los Angeles Lakers 119 Scoring by quarter: 33–29, 32–30, 22–24, 21–36 Pts: Larry Bird 28 Pts: Kareem Abdul-Jabbar 30 Rebs: Larry Bird 14 Rebs: Kareem Abdul-Jabbar 10 Asts: Larry Bird 8 Asts: Magic Johnson 10 <i>Series tied, 3–3</i>	The Forum, Inglewood, California CBS Attendance: 17,505 Referees: ■ No. 14 Jack Madden ■ No. 11 Jake O'Donnell
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In Game 6, the Lakers evened the series with a 119–108 victory. In the game the Lakers answered the Celtics' rough tactics when Laker forward [James Worthy](#) shoved [Cedric Maxwell](#) into a basket support. After the game a Laker fan threw a beer at Celtics guard [M.L. Carr](#) as he left the floor, causing him to label the series "all-out-war."

Game 7

June 12	Los Angeles Lakers 102, Boston Celtics 111 Scoring by quarter: 30–30, 22–28, 26–33, 24–20 Pts: James Worthy 21 Pts: Cedric Maxwell 24 Rebs: Kurt Rambis 9 Rebs: Robert Parish 16 Asts: Magic Johnson 15 Asts: Cedric Maxwell 8 <i>Boston wins the series, 4–3</i>	Boston Garden, Boston, Massachusetts CBS Attendance: 14,890 Referees: ■ No. 10 Darell Garretson ■ No. 12 Earl Strom
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In Game 7, the heat that was an issue in Game 5 was not as bad (indoor temperatures hovered around 91 °F (33 °C) during the game, due to additional fans being brought in to try to cool the air). The Celtics were led by [Cedric Maxwell](#) who had 24 points, eight rebounds and eight assists as they came away with a 111–102 victory. In the game, the Lakers rallied to cut a 14-point-deficit to three with one minute remaining when [Cedric](#)

Maxwell knocked the ball away from Magic Johnson. Dennis Johnson responded by sinking two free throws to seal the victory. Larry Bird was named MVP of the series.

The series was the eighth time in NBA history that the Celtics and Lakers met in the NBA finals, with Boston winning each time, and the first championship that the Celtics claimed at home since 1966.

Player statistics

Legend					
GP	Games played	GS	Games started	MPG	Minutes per game
FG%	Field-goal percentage	3P%	3-point field-goal percentage	FT%	Free-throw percentage
RPG	Rebounds per game	APG	Assists per game	SPG	Steals per game
BPG	Blocks per game	PPG	Points per game		

Boston Celtics

Boston Celtics statistics											
Player	GP	GS	MPG	FG%	3P%	FT%	RPG	APG	SPG	BPG	PPG
<u>Danny Ainge</u>	7	0	14.0	.432	.250	.500	1.1	2.1	0.7	0.0	6.0
<u>Larry Bird</u>	7	7	43.6	.484	.667	.842	14.0	3.6	2.1	1.1	27.4
<u>Quinn Buckner</u>	7	0	8.0	.333	.000	.500	0.9	0.6	0.1	0.0	2.0
<u>M. L. Carr</u>	4	0	7.0	.364	.000	.833	0.8	0.5	0.5	0.0	3.3
<u>Carlos Clark</u>	3	0	3.7	.400	.000	.000	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.3	1.3
<u>Gerald Henderson</u>	7	7	25.6	.468	.000	.667	2.6	4.0	1.4	0.0	12.3
<u>Dennis Johnson</u>	7	7	36.4	.395	.500	.865	3.0	4.7	1.6	0.3	17.6
<u>Greg Kite</u>	4	0	3.3	.250	.000	.000	0.3	0.5	0.0	0.3	0.5
<u>Cedric Maxwell</u>	7	7	34.6	.458	.000	.855	5.6	3.3	1.1	0.3	13.0
<u>Kevin McHale</u>	7	0	30.6	.452	.000	.778	5.9	1.1	0.3	1.1	13.4
<u>Robert Parish</u>	7	7	36.6	.440	.000	.588	11.4	1.3	1.6	1.6	15.4
<u>Scott Wedman</u>	4	0	18.3	.459	.500	.000	5.3	2.5	0.0	0.0	9.3

Los Angeles Lakers

Los Angeles Lakers statistics											
Player	GP	GS	MPG	FG%	3P%	FT%	RPG	APG	SPG	BPG	PPG
<u>Kareem Abdul-Jabbar</u>	7	7	38.9	.481	.000	.679	8.1	4.4	1.7	2.1	26.6
<u>Michael Cooper</u>	7	7	37.4	.468	.500	.773	3.6	5.3	1.1	0.7	13.4
<u>Magic Johnson</u>	7	7	42.1	.560	.000	.744	7.7	13.6	2.0	0.9	18.0
<u>Mitch Kupchak</u>	3	0	4.0	.500	.000	.750	2.3	2.7	0.7	0.0	0.3
<u>Bob McAdoo</u>	6	0	24.3	.459	.000	.655	5.5	0.7	0.3	1.3	12.5
<u>Mike McGee</u>	3	0	14.0	.375	.000	.714	2.7	0.0	0.7	0.3	7.7
<u>Swen Nater</u>	7	0	8.6	.421	.000	.857	3.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	4.0
<u>Kurt Rambis</u>	7	7	22.3	.629	.000	.545	6.4	0.6	0.3	0.3	7.1
<u>Byron Scott</u>	7	0	15.0	.474	.200	.714	1.1	0.7	1.0	0.0	6.0
<u>Larry Spriggs</u>	2	0	3.5	.667	.000	.000	1.0	0.5	0.0	0.0	2.0
<u>Jamaal Wilkes</u>	7	0	14.1	.448	.000	.750	1.9	0.4	0.3	0.0	4.6
<u>James Worthy</u>	7	7	39.1	.638	.000	.656	4.4	2.3	1.4	0.3	22.1

Team rosters

Boston Celtics

1983–84 Boston Celtics roster									
Players							Coaches		
Pos. ↕	No. ↕	Player	Height	Weight	DOB	From	Head coach		
G/F	44	<u>Danny Ainge</u>	6 ft 4 in (1.93 m)	175 lb (79 kg)	1959–03–17	<u>BYU</u>	▪ <u>K.C. Jones</u>	Assistant(s)	
F	33	<u>Larry Bird</u>	6 ft 9 in (2.06 m)	220 lb (100 kg)	1956–12–07	<u>Indiana State</u>			
G	28	<u>Quinn Buckner</u>	6 ft 3 in (1.91 m)	190 lb (86 kg)	1954–08–20	<u>Indiana</u>	▪ <u>Jimmy Rodgers</u>		
G/F	30	<u>M.L. Carr</u>	6 ft 6 in (1.98 m)	205 lb (93 kg)	1951–01–09	<u>Guilford</u>			
G	40	<u>Carlos Clark</u>	6 ft 4 in (1.93 m)	210 lb (95 kg)	1960–08–10	<u>Mississippi</u>	▪ <u>Chris Ford</u>		
G	43	<u>Gerald Henderson</u>	6 ft 2 in (1.88 m)	175 lb (79 kg)	1956–01–16	<u>VCU</u>			
G	3	<u>Dennis Johnson</u>	6 ft 4 in (1.93 m)	182 lb (83 kg)	1954–09–18	<u>Pepperdine</u>	Legend ▪ (DP) Unsigned draft pick ▪ (FA) Free agent		
C	50	<u>Greg Kite</u>	6 ft 11 in (2.11 m)	250 lb (113 kg)	1961–08–05	<u>BYU</u>			
F	31	<u>Cedric Maxwell</u>	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	205 lb (93 kg)	1955–11–21	<u>Charlotte</u>			

Pos.	No.	Player	Height	Weight	DOB	From	(S) Suspended
F/C	32	Kevin McHale	6 ft 10 in (2.08 m)	210 lb (95 kg)	1957–12–19	Minnesota	+
C	00	Robert Parish	7 ft 0 in (2.13 m)	230 lb (104 kg)	1953–08–30	Centenary	
G/F	8	Scott Wedman	6 ft 7 in (2.01 m)	215 lb (98 kg)	1952–07–29	Colorado	

Los Angeles Lakers

1983–84 Los Angeles Lakers roster							
Players						Coaches	
Pos.	No.	Player	Height	Weight	DOB	From	Head coach
C	33	Kareem Abdul-Jabbar	7 ft 2 in (2.18 m)	225 lb (102 kg)	1947–04–16	UCLA	Pat Riley Assistant(s) Bill Bertka Dave Wohl
G	21	Michael Cooper	6 ft 5 in (1.96 m)	170 lb (77 kg)	1956–04–15	New Mexico	
F	0	Calvin Garrett	6 ft 7 in (2.01 m)	190 lb (86 kg)	1956–07–11	Oral Roberts	
G	32	Magic Johnson	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	215 lb (98 kg)	1959–08–14	Michigan State	Legend (DP) Unsigned draft pick (FA) Free agent (S) Suspended +

Television coverage

The 1984 championship series scored high TV ratings. All the playoff action was documented on the 1984 NBA Season documentary *Pride and Passion*, narrated by Dick Stockton. Stockton, the play-by-play announcer for the series, was joined by Tom Heinsohn, and the duo would call the next four NBA Finals until 1987.

Legacy and Aftermath

Reflecting back on the series, Magic Johnson said ". . . (the Lakers) learned a valuable lesson. Only the strong survive. . . talent just don't get it. That's the first time the (80's) Lakers ever encountered that, someone stronger minded."^[9] Johnson himself would receive tremendous criticism for his performance in the Finals by fans and media, after being thoroughly outplayed by rival Larry Bird.^{[10][11]} Following the Finals, he was jokingly named "Tragic Johnson" for his performance in the series.^{[12][13]}

Both teams met again in the Finals the next year, although a bar fight involving Larry Bird outside a Boston bar (Chelsea's) during the 1985 Eastern Conference Finals impacted the Celtics in the series.^[14] Bird suffered a temporary finger injury which affected his play; he struggled in the last two games of the Eastern Conference Finals against the Sixers and throughout the 1985 Finals. In the series, the Lakers returned the favor and defeated the Celtics in six games, clinching the title at Boston Garden after years of torment and bad misfortune at the arena. The Celtics would then win their next championship two years later over the Hakeem Olajuwon-led Houston Rockets in six games. The Celtics and Lakers met for the third time in the 1980s in 1987, which the Lakers also won in six games. Johnson, who by then had shaken and outgrown the "Tragic Johnson" nickname, would win his third NBA Finals MVP in the series, highlighted by a "baby sky hook" game winner in Game 4.^[15]

In Popular Culture

The 1984 NBA Finals (as well as the 1985 and 1987 Finals) has been covered in-depth in many documentaries, including ESPN's 30 for 30 *Celtics/Lakers: Best of Enemies*, HBO's *Celtics City* and *Magic & Bird: A Courtship of Rivals*.

The 1984 Finals was dramatized in the Season 2 of HBO's *Winning Time: The Rise of the Lakers Dynasty*, which was based on the book *Showtime: Magic, Kareem, Riley, and the Los Angeles Lakers Dynasty of the 1980s* by Jeff Pearlman.^[16]

See also

- 1984 NBA playoffs

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External links

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 - *Boston Globe* story about Game 5 (published 7 June 2009) (http://archive.boston.com/sports/basketball/celtics/articles/2009/06/07/in_84_it_was_hot_stuff/)
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